

Kalmely.

The 10-Minute Cushion Release Guide

*Your companion to releasing the Cushion Hump —
ten passive minutes at a time*

A GIFT FROM KALMELY

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1. Welcome — and One Thing You Need to Hear First

Hi. We're so glad you're here.

Your Gravity Cradle is on its way (or maybe it's already sitting on your nightstand), and this little book is our welcome gift to you. Before you use the Cradle for the first time, we'd like ten minutes of your time — because there's something you need to hear, and we suspect no one has ever said it to you plainly.

The bump at the base of your neck was never your fault.

Not your posture. Not your desk. Not laziness, not “letting yourself go,” not failing to sit up straight like your mother told you. You could have done everything right — and many of the women we hear from did — and it still would have appeared.

Here's the short version, and the next chapter tells the full story: somewhere in your late forties or fifties, your body went through a quiet chemical shift, and your spine felt it as strain. Your body did what bodies do when they sense strain — it protected you. It built a soft pad of tight tissue and trapped fluid over your lowest neck vertebra, like a built-in shoulder pad. We call it **the Cushion Hump**. Then, as the years passed and the tension never let up, that cushion stiffened in place.

So the hump isn't a sign that your body failed you. It's a sign that your body was *defending* you — with materials that later locked up. And that's also why the braces, the corrections, the “shoulders back!” never worked: they pushed against a protective response, and your protection system pushed back. You weren't doing anything wrong. You were in a tug-of-war with your own defenses, and that's a war nobody wins.

What that system responds to isn't force. It's *safety* — a gentle, sustained signal that says: you can let go now. That's exactly the signal the Gravity Cradle is built to send, using nothing more than the weight of your own head.

What you'll find in this guide

In the pages ahead, we'll walk you through:

- The full story of the Cushion Hump — what it's made of, and why it grew after menopause
- Why force-based approaches backfired, in plain language
- Exactly how to use your Gravity Cradle: ten minutes, lying down, doing nothing
- What to expect week by week, and how to notice progress honestly
- Small, kind habits that support the release (no punishing routines — we promise)

Our honest promise

We won't oversell you, because you've been oversold before.

Some of what sits at the base of your neck may include changes to the bone itself, and no device — ours included — changes bone. What the Gravity Cradle works on is the soft cushion layered on top of it, which for most women is a meaningful part of what they see and feel.

The commitment is ten minutes a day, lying on your back, head resting directly on the Cradle. That's it. No reps, no discipline, no willpower. The change is gradual — most women describe the area feeling softer and less tense first, with visible changes coming slowly over the following weeks.

One note before you begin: if you've had neck surgery or have a diagnosed spinal condition, please check with your doctor first.

For years, your body has been holding on — protecting you the only way it knew how.

Starting today, you're going to teach it that it's safe to let go.

Welcome to Kalmely. Now let's introduce you, properly, to what's actually living at the base of your neck.

2. Meet Your Cushion Hump

You've probably stood at the mirror, turned sideways, and thought: *that's bone. That's my spine changing shape. That's permanent.*

Take a breath. It's almost certainly not what you think.

It's not all bone

Yes, there are vertebrae under there. And to be fully honest with you: some women do have a bony component to the curve, and no device changes bone. But in most women, the part you can see and hate — the raised, rounded mound — is something else entirely.

It's soft tissue. A dense cushion of tight muscle, stiffened connective tissue, and trapped fluid that your body stacked *on top of* your last big vertebra.

Why would your body do that? Because it was trying to protect you.

When your neck and upper spine spend years under tension, your body does what bodies do: it guards the vulnerable spot. It layers padding over it. It braces the muscles around it. It parks fluid there. The mound you see is not decay — it's armor. Your body built a cushion over a spine it believed was under threat.

That's why we call it the Cushion Hump. Not the bone hump. The *cushion*.

Try the press test — right now

Don't just take our word for it. Put this down for a moment, reach back with two fingers, and press gently into the mound at the base of your neck.

Notice something? It gives. Maybe just a little. Maybe it feels dense, knotted, "hard as a rock" — but it *yields* under your fingers.

Bone doesn't yield. What you just felt soften slightly under your own fingertips is tissue. And tissue that can be pressed can, over time, be released.

Keep that feeling in your memory. It's the most important piece of evidence you'll touch in this whole book.

Why it showed up after menopause

Here's the part nobody explained to you — not your doctor, not the posture videos, not the chiropractor.

When estrogen falls, two quiet things happen:

- **Your collagen loses its stretch.** The connective tissue that used to glide and rebound becomes stiffer, drier, less forgiving. Tissue that once released tension on its own now holds onto it.
- **Your cortisol rises.** Higher stress hormones keep muscles in a low-grade clench — especially the ones guarding your neck.

So the cushion your body had been quietly building for years didn't stay soft. It seized. It set. Almost overnight, it seemed, there was a mound where there hadn't been one.

You didn't slouch your way into this. You didn't fail at posture. Your hormones changed the material your body is made of, and no one told you. It was never your fault.

Meet the guardian — and why everything you tried backfired

Think of the muscles around your Cushion Hump as a guardian. A loyal, slightly overprotective guardian whose only job is to shield your spine.

Now look back at everything you've tried:

- **Braces and posture correctors** yanked your shoulders back. The guardian felt the pull and clenched harder to resist it — and your head drifted forward to compensate.
- **Chiropractic adjustments** applied sudden force. Relief for a day, maybe — then the guardian, startled, locked things down tighter than before.
- **Exercises and stretching routines** asked you to *fight* the tension. But a guardian under attack doesn't retreat. It digs in.

None of these failed because you were lazy or inconsistent. They failed because they were aimed at the wrong layer — and because force, to a protective nervous system, reads as *threat*. The harder you pushed, the harder the guardian pushed back.

What the guardian actually responds to

A guardian doesn't stand down when you fight it. It stands down when it feels safe.

That's what a gentle, sustained release does. No yanking, no cracking, no effort. Just a slow, steady signal — held long enough for your nervous system to believe it — that says: *the threat is over. You can let go.*

When the guardian relaxes, the muscles ease. When the muscles ease, the trapped fluid can drain. And when the fluid drains, the cushion begins to soften and settle. For most women this happens gradually — softening you feel first, changes you may notice later.

You've met your Cushion Hump. Now let's get you set up to send that signal of safety for the very first time.

3. Before Your First Session

You've unboxed your Gravity Cradle. Maybe you've turned it over in your hands and thought, *this little thing?* That's a fair reaction. So before you lie down for the first time, let's set you up properly — because a few small choices in these first few minutes make a real difference in how quickly your body decides to trust it.

Remember what the Cradle is doing: it isn't forcing anything. It's inviting the tight cushion at the base of your neck to release. Your job tonight is simply to make that invitation easy to accept.

Where: your bed is perfect

You don't need a hard floor. In fact, for most women, the bed is better — your body relaxes faster somewhere it already associates with rest, and a firm mattress gives the Cradle all the support it needs.

Set it up like this:

- Lay the Cradle **flat on the mattress**, curved side up, roughly where your pillow usually sits.
- **Move your pillow aside completely.** This is the one that surprises people: your head rests directly on the Cradle, nothing underneath it. A pillow would lift your head and cancel the gentle traction you're here for.
- Lie down on your back and settle the base of your skull — that soft groove right where your head meets your neck — into the cradle's contour.
- Let your **chin tilt slightly upward**, toward the ceiling. Not craned back, just released. If your chin is tucked toward your chest, scoot down an inch.

Wear whatever is comfortable — pajamas are ideal. Just avoid a stiff collar, a bulky hood, or a ponytail clip sitting right where your head meets the Cradle. Hair down or in a loose side braid works best.

When: the last ten minutes of your day

You can use the Cradle any time, but nighttime — right before sleep — is when it works hardest for you. Your cortisol is winding down, your muscles are already looking for permission to let go, and whatever softens during your session gets a full night of stillness to settle. Many women tell us it's become the moment their day officially ends.

A quick word on safety

If you've had neck or spinal surgery, or you've been diagnosed with a spinal condition, please check with your doctor before your first session. This isn't fine print — it's respect for your history. The Cradle is gentle, but your doctor knows your neck better than we do.

What you'll feel the first time

Here's the honest preview, so nothing catches you off guard.

The first minute is the most intense. You'll feel a firm, steady pressure at the base of your skull — most women describe it as *two thumbs pressing exactly where the tension lives*. That spot has been clenched for a long time, so at first the pressure can feel strong, even a little strange. This is normal. It's the feeling of tissue that forgot how to soften being asked, kindly, to remember.

Then something shifts. Somewhere between minute one and minute three, most women feel the intensity fade and a warm, spreading heaviness take its place — like the back of your neck is exhaling for the first time in years. Your shoulders may drop away from your ears on their own. Let them.

There's nothing to do during a session. No holding, no engaging, no "good posture." The whole point is that your head's own weight — about ten pounds of it — does the work while you do absolutely nothing. If you notice yourself trying, smile and stop. You've earned the right to be still.

Start with 3–4 minutes, not 10

This matters. For your first several nights, keep sessions to **three or four minutes**, even if it feels wonderful and you want to stay. Tissue that has guarded itself for years releases best in small, repeated doses — and easing in keeps you from waking up with next-day tenderness, which is common when people rush it.

Over the next week or two, as the pressure starts to feel less like *two thumbs* and more like a familiar hello, add a minute or two each night until you reach **ten minutes**. That's the full session. You never need more.

One more thing before you lie down: you don't have to feel anything dramatic tonight. Some women feel the warm release on night one; for others it arrives quietly over the first week or two. Both are normal. Consistency, not intensity, is what tells your body it's finally safe to let go.

Ready? Here's the full method, step by step.

4. The 10-Minute Method, Step by Step

You don't need to be flexible. You don't need to be strong. You don't even need to change into workout clothes.

You need a floor or a firm bed, your Gravity Cradle, and ten minutes where nobody needs you. That's the whole list.

Here's exactly how to do it — and how to know you're doing it right.

Step 1: Place the Cradle where your skull ends

Sit down next to your Gravity Cradle and find the spot first with your fingers: reach behind your head and feel where your skull curves under, right at the top of your neck. That bony shelf — the base of the skull — is where the Cradle belongs.

Not on the middle of your neck. Not anywhere near your throat. The Cradle supports the *skull*, and the gentle pull happens below it, on its own.

Step 2: Lie back — slowly

Lie down on your back and lower your head onto the Cradle so that the ridge tucks under the base of your skull. No pillow. Your head rests directly on the device.

The first few seconds may feel unfamiliar — a firm, specific pressure where you're used to softness. That's normal. Unfamiliar is not the same as wrong. If anything feels sharp, or presses on your throat, you're placed too low: slide the Cradle up toward your skull until the pressure feels deep and dull, like a thumb in exactly the right spot.

Step 3: Let your arms fall

Rest your arms at your sides, palms up if that's comfortable. Palms-up quietly invites your shoulders to open instead of hunch.

Now do a quick check: are your shoulders creeping up toward your ears? Let them drop. You'll probably have to let them drop three or four times in the first minutes — that's the Cushion Hump's old habit talking, not a mistake on your part.

Step 4: Breathe long and slow

This step matters more than it looks. Breathe in through your nose for a slow count of 4. Breathe out for a slow count of 6.

That longer exhale is a message. It tells your nervous system, in the only language it trusts: *we're safe, you can stand down*. And when the nervous system stands down, the tight tissue at the base of your neck finally gets permission to soften. You're not forcing anything to release — you're making it safe to.

Step 5: Give your mind somewhere to go

Ten minutes of lying still can feel long the first week. Put on a podcast, a favorite album, or nothing at all — whatever keeps you from watching the clock. Many women fold this into something they already do: the end of a morning coffee, the first quiet minutes after dinner.

The only rule: no phone held above your face. That craned position works against everything the Cradle is doing.

Step 6: Stay for 10 minutes

Set a gentle timer. Most women feel the tension begin to ease somewhere in the middle — a slow settling, like a held breath finally let out. Some days you'll feel a lot; some days, almost nothing. Both count. This works by gentle repetition, not by intensity.

Step 7: Get up the kind way

When the timer goes, don't sit straight up. Roll onto your side, rest there for a breath or two, then press yourself up with your arm. Slow is the point — you've just asked your neck to let go, so don't ask it to snap back to attention.

The three most common mistakes

- **Placing it too low.** On the neck instead of under the skull. If you feel pressure near your throat, slide it up. The Cradle holds the skull; gravity does the rest.
- **Trying to help.** Tucking the chin, stretching, pushing into the device. Remember the guardian from chapter 2: effort reads as threat to a guarded neck, and a threatened neck grips tighter. Your only job is to rest.
- **Braced shoulders.** Shoulders up by the ears work against the release. Check them once a minute at first. Letting them drop *is* the exercise.

That's the method. Ten minutes, no effort, no willpower required. The Cradle holds you — for once, you don't have to hold anything.

So what happens next, and when? Let's look at the honest timeline.

5. What to Expect, Week by Week

You've spent years being promised overnight miracles — and years being disappointed by them. So let's not do that here.

This chapter is the honest version. It's what most women actually experience when they use the Gravity Cradle for ten minutes a day, and just as important, what they *don't*. Your body built the Cushion Hump slowly, layer by layer, to protect you. It releases the same way it was built: gradually, in the right order, on its own timeline.

Here's the map.

Session one: the release

The first thing most women notice isn't in the mirror — it's a feeling.

Somewhere in those first ten minutes, as your head settles and the gentle traction takes over, something at the base of your neck lets go. Women describe it as a slow exhale in a muscle they didn't know was holding its breath. Some feel a wave of warmth. A few get quietly emotional, which makes sense — those muscles have been clenched for a long time.

This release is real, but it's temporary at first. That's normal. One session tells your nervous system it's safe to soften. It takes repetition to convince it.

Weeks 1–2: the grip starts to loosen

With daily use, the changes show up in how your neck *feels*:

- Morning stiffness eases — you turn your head on the pillow without that locked, “concrete” feeling
- The constant background pull at the base of your neck gets quieter
- The release you feel during a session starts lasting longer afterward

Nothing dramatic in the mirror yet. This phase is happening under the surface: tense tissue is learning to stay soft between sessions, and that has to come first.

Weeks 3–4: the cushion softens

This is where your fingertips notice before your eyes do. When you press on the area, most women find it feels softer — less like a firm, fixed mound and more like tissue that gives a little. Your neck moves more freely; checking your blind spot in the car stops being a whole-body event.

And around week four, with consistent daily use, most women start to see a difference in the mirror. Not a transformation — a difference. The area looks a touch less prominent. Clothes sit a little differently across the shoulders.

If you're not there yet at week four, you haven't failed. Bodies vary, and the women who carried this tension the longest often need a little more time.

Weeks 6–8 and beyond: settling in

As the softened tissue continues to drain and settle, the changes compound quietly:

- The area at the base of your neck gradually settles and looks less raised
- Your neckline and the slope of your shoulders look more defined
- The relaxed, released feeling becomes your new baseline instead of a treat

Many women say this is when someone else notices — a husband, a daughter, a friend who can't put her finger on what's different.

What not to expect

In fairness to you, here's the other side:

- **Overnight change.** Anyone who promises that is selling you disappointment.
- **A perfectly straight line of progress.** Some weeks leap ahead; some plateau. Both are normal.

- **A completely flat result for everyone.** As we said when we introduced the Cushion Hump: some humps include a bony component that no device — ours included — can change. What the Gravity Cradle works on is the soft cushion of tense tissue and trapped fluid sitting on top of it, and for most women, that cushion is a meaningful part of what they see. Reducing its appearance is real progress, honestly earned.

About the bad days

You will have them. A stressful week, a poor night's sleep, a long drive — and suddenly the neck feels tight again and the mirror looks unkind. On those days it's easy to think you're back at square one.

You're not. A bad day doesn't erase weeks of released tissue any more than one rainy afternoon erases a whole spring. Do your ten minutes anyway — bad days are when your body needs that signal of safety most.

Your sessions do the releasing. The next chapter is about the rest of your day — and how to stop it from quietly taking that release back.

6. The Habits That Help It Stay Released

Here's some good news you may not be expecting: this chapter is not a workout plan.

You will not find a single rep, resistance band, or “just do this every hour!” chart in the pages ahead. You've been handed enough of those — and if they were going to work for your body, they would have by now. That was never your fault. A tense, guarded cushion doesn't respond to more effort. It responds to less strain.

So think of what follows as small kindnesses, not corrections. Your Gravity Cradle sessions do the releasing. These little habits simply stop your day from quietly re-tightening what your sessions have softened. Pick the ones that fit your life. Even two or three make a real difference for most women.

Bring things up to your eyes — not your eyes down to things

Every hour your chin drops toward a phone or a book in your lap, the base of your neck carries extra load, and the tissue over that last vertebra braces to protect you. You don't need perfect posture — you just need the screen higher. Prop your phone on a cushion at chest height, rest your book against a pillow on the table, raise your monitor on a couple of thick books. Let the object come to you.

One pillow, medium height — not a pillow tower

If you've been stacking two pillows to “get comfortable,” your neck is spending all night folded forward — eight hours of the exact position we're trying to release. Aim for one medium pillow that keeps your head level with your spine when you lie on your back or side, not tilted up toward the ceiling. It may feel oddly flat for the first few nights. Give it a week; most women stop noticing, and their mornings feel looser.

Drink water like it's part of the plan — because it is

Remember, part of what makes the Cushion Hump feel thick and stubborn is trapped fluid, and fluid drains best through well-hydrated tissue. You don't need a gallon jug or

an app scolding you. Just keep a glass nearby and refill it a few times a day, especially on the days you use your Cradle. Think of it as helping the drain do its job.

A warm shower before your session

Warmth tells clenched muscle it's safe — which is exactly the message your session is about to send. If you can, take your ten minutes on the Cradle right after a hot shower, or lay a warm compress across the base of your neck for a few minutes first. Softened tissue lets go more easily. It's the difference between stretching cold taffy and warm taffy.

Switch shoulders with your bag

That purse or tote you've carried on the same shoulder for thirty years? It asks one side of your neck to grip, all day, every day. Switch sides every time you pick it up — or better, lighten it. You don't have to give up the bag you love. Just stop asking the same muscles to guard it forever.

If you knit, read, or drive a lot: little “look up” breaks

Long stretches with your head held in one position — a knitting project, a good novel, a two-hour drive — invite the tissue to stiffen back into guard mode. Every twenty or thirty minutes, simply lift your eyes to the horizon, let your shoulders drop away from your ears, and take one slow breath. That's it. No stretching routine, no timer stress. Just a brief reminder to your body that it's allowed to unclench.

The spirit of all of this

None of these habits requires discipline, sweat, or a new identity. They ask almost nothing — which is exactly why they work alongside a release that's built on gentleness, not force. Your body has spent years bracing. These are the quiet, daily signals that it can finally stand down.

And on the days you forget every single one of them? Nothing is lost. Lie back on your Cradle, let your head rest, and begin again. Gradual is not a consolation prize here — gradual is the method.

If you'd like one more small kindness for your mornings, the next chapter has a short, optional ritual. And we do mean optional.

7. A Gentle 3-Minute Morning Wake-Up (Optional)

Let's be clear about one thing before we begin: **you don't have to do this.**

Your Gravity Cradle does its work while you rest. That's the whole point. The tension at the base of your neck didn't come from a lack of effort on your part — so it won't be released by adding more effort now.

But some women tell us they like a small morning ritual. Something quiet, just for them, before the day starts asking things of them. If that sounds like you, here it is: three minutes, four movements, all of them soft.

Think of it as saying good morning to your neck — not giving it orders.

One rule above everything: no pain, no forcing

By now you know how the Cushion Hump works: when it feels force, it grips tighter; when it feels safety, it can begin to soften. So through every movement below:

- Move at about half the speed you think you should.
- Stay well inside the comfortable range. You should feel a gentle stretch at most — never a pinch, never a strain.
- If anything hurts, stop. That's not quitting; that's listening. You can simply try again tomorrow, smaller.
- Because this chapter involves movement, one extra reminder: if you've had neck or spine surgery, or a diagnosed spinal condition, check with your doctor before adding any of this.

The routine

You can do all of this sitting on the edge of your bed, still in your pajamas.

1. Slow neck turns (about 45 seconds) Sitting tall but relaxed, slowly turn your head to look toward one shoulder — only as far as feels easy. Pause for a breath. Slowly come back to center. Then the other side. Three or four turns each way, unhurried. You're not trying to increase the range. You're just reminding your neck that it's allowed to move.

2. Shoulder rolls: up, back, and down (five times) Breathe in and let your shoulders drift up toward your ears. Then roll them gently back, and let them settle down as you breathe out. Five slow rolls. That “down” at the end is the good part — let it feel like setting down a bag you've been carrying.

3. The gentle chin nod (about 30 seconds) You may have been taught the “chin tuck” — that forceful jam-your-chin-back exercise. This is not that. Instead: imagine you're nodding a small, slow yes to someone you love. The chin drops a tiny bit, the back of your neck lengthens a little, and then you release. Five or six soft nods. Tiny is correct here. Tiny is the whole technique.

4. Trapezius stretch with your hand (30 seconds per side) Sit on one hand, palm down, to keep that shoulder settled. Let your ear tilt gently toward the opposite shoulder — don't pull, just let the weight of your head do it. If it feels nice, you can rest your free hand lightly on the side of your head. Not pressing. Just resting, like a warm compress. Three slow breaths, then switch sides.

That's it. Three minutes, and most of it is breathing.

Why gentle works here

Everything in this little routine follows the same logic as your Gravity Cradle: a soft, sustained invitation instead of a demand. Slow movement and easy breath tell your nervous system that the threat has passed — and when it believes that, the muscles at the base of your neck can begin to let go.

Pushing harder doesn't speed that up. It usually does the opposite.

If you skip it, nothing is lost

Some mornings you'll do this. Some mornings you'll pour your coffee and forget it exists. Both are fine. Your Cradle sessions don't depend on it, and neither does your progress.

This isn't homework. You've had enough of that. It's simply a small kindness you can offer your neck on the mornings you feel like it — and a kindness declined is still a kindness you own.

There's one more skill worth learning before we send you off: how to actually see slow, gentle progress. Because your everyday eyes will miss it.

8. Troubleshooting — Every Question, Answered

Every woman's first weeks with the Cradle look a little different. Here are the questions we hear most — answered plainly, the way we'd tell a friend.

“I feel a little dizzy afterwards.”

This usually means two things: the session ran a bit long for where your neck is right now, or you sat up too quickly.

Shorten your sessions to 3–4 minutes for a few days and build back up gradually. And when your ten minutes are done, don't pop straight up — roll gently onto your side, pause for a breath or two, and rise slowly. Your neck has just spent years clenched; give it a moment to adjust to letting go.

If dizziness continues session after session, stop and check with your doctor.

“It feels uncomfortable at first.”

Completely normal for the first week. The contours press right where the tension lives, and tissue that has been guarding for years doesn't love being asked to soften on day one.

Start with 3–4 minutes a night and work up to the full ten as the intensity fades — and it does fade. Most women tell us that same firm pressure becomes the most relaxing part of their day by week two. Uncomfortable is acceptable. Pain is not — more on that below.

“Two weeks in and I don't see anything in the mirror.”

You're right on schedule.

Remember the two timelines: *feeling* comes first, *seeing* comes later. By week two, most women notice the area is less stiff, mornings feel lighter, and the spot yields a little more under their fingers. The mirror usually catches up around week four of daily use.

Use the weekly press test as your in-between measure: reach back and press. Softer than last week? It's working — whether the mirror admits it yet or not.

“Can I use it on the sofa or the floor?”

Yes to both. The only rule: the Cradle needs a reasonably firm surface under it. A very soft, deep sofa cushion swallows the base and steals some of the gentle pull.

Your bed works perfectly — that's where most women use it. A carpeted floor is fine too, if getting down and up again is comfortable for you. No need to camp on hard tile.

“Would 20 minutes work twice as fast?”

We understand the temptation — and no.

The release responds to *consistency*, not intensity. Ten minutes, every day, gently repeated, is what convinces your nervous system it's safe to let go. Long, occasional sessions ask too much at once and deliver less. This is one of the rare corners of life where doing less, more often, wins.

“What if I fall asleep on it?”

It happens — it's that relaxing. But the Cradle is designed for a ten-minute session, not a night's sleep.

If you doze off for a few extra minutes, no harm done; don't worry about it. Just don't make it your pillow. Finish your session, set the Cradle on the nightstand, and sleep the way you normally do.

“It hurts afterwards.”

Stop here, because this one matters.

Mild pressure during the session and a gentle, warm awareness afterwards — that's the release working. But actual pain after a session, pain that lingers or sharpens, is your body saying something we should listen to. Stop using the Cradle and check in with your doctor before continuing.

And as always: if you've had neck surgery or have a diagnosed spinal condition, clear it with your doctor before your first session.

One more thing, for every question above: you can't get this wrong in any way that ten minutes and a small adjustment won't fix. Be patient with your neck. It's been protecting you for years — it's allowed a little time to trust the quiet.

9. Track Your Release (The Photo Trick)

Here is something nobody tells you about slow, gentle progress: you are the worst possible judge of it.

Not because anything is wrong with you. Because you see yourself every single day — and change that happens a little at a time is invisible to daily eyes. You never noticed your hair growing, either. But your hairdresser does, every six weeks.

So in this chapter, we're going to borrow the hairdresser's trick. We're going to give you three simple ways to see what's actually happening — without turning your neck into a daily obsession.

Why the daily mirror lies to you

The mirror is honest about *today*. It is terrible at comparing today to six weeks ago.

Your brain quietly updates its picture of you every time you look. Yesterday's you becomes the new “normal,” so gradual softening gets absorbed into the background. Add in the things that change hour to hour — how tense your shoulders are, how you slept, the lighting, even how much fluid your body is holding that day — and the daily mirror becomes noise, not signal.

Worse, checking every day trains you to hunt for the bump. And you've spent enough years doing that.

Check less. Compare smarter.

Tool 1: The monthly profile photo

This is the one that matters most. Once a month — pick a date you'll remember, like the 1st — take one photo of yourself from the side.

Keep the conditions the same every time:

- **Same wall.** Plain background, same spot in your home.

- **Same light.** Daytime, near the same window, or the same lamp. Light changes shadows, and shadows change how the curve looks.
- **Hair up.** A simple ponytail or clip, so the base of your neck is visible.
- **Same posture.** Just stand comfortably — don't stretch tall, don't slump. You want the truth, not a performance.
- **Someone you trust takes it,** or use a mirror selfie from the side. Either works, as long as it's the same method each month.

Then put your phone away. Don't stare at it. The photo isn't for today — it's for the month-after-month comparison, where gradual change finally becomes visible. Most women who see softening see it there first, side by side, not in the mirror.

Tool 2: The weekly press test

You did the press test back in chapter 2 — now it becomes your progress check. Once a week — not daily — reach back and gently press the soft area at the base of your neck with two fingers.

You're not measuring size. You're feeling *texture*. When tension begins to release and fluid begins to drain, the area often feels a little less firm under your fingers first — springier, less like a knot that pushes back. That softening usually shows up before anything shows up in a photo. And remember what your fingers are checking: the soft cushion on top, the part that can soften and settle — not the bone beneath it.

Tool 3: The closet test

This one is our favorite, because it isn't a measurement at all. It's your life coming back.

Somewhere in your closet there are things you quietly stopped wearing — the V-neck, the scoop collar, the blouse that sits open at the back, the ponytail on a warm day. Once a month, try one on. Notice how you feel about being seen in it.

The day you wear your hair up and don't think about it until dinnertime? That's data too. Some would say the best kind.

Celebrate the small signals

Progress here is quiet, and it arrives in small pieces: the press test feels a bit softer. The morning stiffness eases sooner. Your ten minutes on the Cradle start to feel like the best part of the day instead of a chore.

Write these down when you notice them — one line on the back of a calendar is enough. Small signals are how a slow release announces itself. You spent years being hard on yourself over this. Tracking is where you get to practice the opposite: noticing what's going right, at the pace real bodies actually change.

One photo a month. One gentle press a week. One blouse from the back of the closet. That's the whole system.

Now — one last chapter, about the season ahead.

10. Your 90 Days — and Where to Find Us

You've reached the end of this little book, but you're standing at the beginning of something better: the next 90 days.

We chose that number on purpose. Ninety days is long enough for real change and short enough to feel doable. It's roughly one season of your life — one summer, one fall. You've already given this problem years. You can give the answer one season.

Why 90 days, and not 90 hours

Here's the honest truth, the one we'd want a friend to tell us: the Cushion Hump didn't stack up overnight, and it won't settle overnight either.

Your body spent years building that cushion to guard you — you know that story now. So we're not asking it to change in a weekend. We're asking it, gently and daily, to feel safe enough to let go. For most women, that unwinding follows the map from chapter 5: the position becomes familiar and the tension at the base of the skull eases first (weeks 1–2), the tissue begins to feel softer to the touch (weeks 3–6), and then the daily minutes compound — as the muscles release and the trapped fluid drains, the cushion can soften and settle, and the appearance of the hump may gradually reduce (weeks 7–12).

Every body has its own timeline, and yours may move faster or slower than this. Some of what sits at the base of your neck may be bone — and we won't pretend a cradle changes bone. But the soft, tense cushion your body stacked on top? That part responds to a gentle, sustained release. That's the part we're working on together.

The habit that carries you there

You don't need discipline. You don't need a program, a chart, or a gym bag. You need ten minutes, flat on your back, head resting on the Cradle — and you need it to become as automatic as brushing your teeth.

That's the whole secret. Not intensity — consistency. Attach it to something you already do every day: right after your morning coffee, or right before you turn out the light. Same time, same spot, every day. By week three, skipping it will feel stranger than doing it.

And if you miss a day? You haven't failed anything. Just lie down tomorrow. The body doesn't keep score of one missed day. It responds to the pattern.

We read every email — really

Kalmely is a small team, and this is not a line we put in every book: when you write to us, a person reads it.

If something feels confusing, if you're not sure you're positioned right, if week four feels discouraging — write to us at **hello@kalmely.com**. We'll answer.

And when something shifts — the morning you touch the base of your neck and it feels softer, the day you pull your hair up without thinking twice — please tell us that too. Those emails get passed around the whole team. They're the reason we do this.

One note on safety before we let you go: if you've had neck or spinal surgery, or you have a diagnosed spinal condition, please check with your doctor before starting your daily sessions.

One last thing

If you take a single sentence from this book, let it be this one:

You were never lazy, and it was never your fault — your body just needed to feel safe enough to let go.

Not one more posture lecture. Not one more “just stand up straight.” You didn't cause this by slouching, and you won't release it by forcing. You'll release the tension the same way it came: gently, daily, one quiet ten-minute session at a time.

Your body has been protecting you all these years. Now you get to return the favor.

Welcome to Kalmely. We're so glad you're here.

With warmth, The Kalmely Team

A note on what this book is — and isn't

The Gravity Cradle is a wellness and relaxation device, not a medical treatment, and nothing in this book is medical advice or a substitute for it. This guide does not diagnose, treat, or prevent any condition. Individual experiences vary, results are gradual, and no specific outcome is promised or guaranteed. If you have — or suspect you have — a medical condition, or if you have had neck or spinal surgery or a diagnosed spinal condition, consult your physician before use. Stop and seek medical advice if you experience pain, numbness, or tingling. © Kalmely. All rights reserved.

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This guide is general information, not medical advice. The Gravity Cradle is a wellness device and is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent any disease. If you've had neck surgery or have a diagnosed spinal condition, check with your doctor first.